Minutes of the Royal Netherlands Astronomical Society (Koninklijke Nederlandse Astronomenclub) Annual General Meeting 2025

Berg en Dal, Netherlands

Total Members Present at the opening of the meeting: 13 plus the following

Board Members Present: Marijke Haverkorn (chairperson, incoming), Jake Noel-Storr (secretary), Ralph Wijers (treasurer, outgoing), Steven Rieder (treasurer, incoming), Sven De Rijcke, Katie Mulrey

External Audit Committee Members Present: Vince Icke, Frank Pijpers

Apologies Received: Peter Barthel (chairperson, outgoing), Rudolf Le Poole, Dieter Heymann

0. Preamble:

The Chair shared the mission of the society as reads:

The society wants to be THE platform for professional and former astronomers, it fosters contacts between them, and stimulates and supports actions towards the societal goals concerning the promotion of astronomy in The Netherlands and Flanders.

The one-and-only professional organization of astronomers and space researchers in NL/B

Please visit the website www.kna-rnas.nl

1. Opening and adoption of the agenda

Meeting opened by the chair at 15:20h on 27th May, 2025 in the Fletcher Landgoed Hotel Holthurnsche Hof, Berg en Dal, Netherlands, during the 80th Netherlands Astronomy Conference, organized by our Radboud University Colleagues.

1.1. Agenda as announced adopted without objection

2. Board announcements

2.1. Apologies given as above

2.2. New Board Member Steven Rieder has been acting-co-treasurer, and will be treasurer from this meeting onwards with Ralph Wijers as co-treasurer.

3. Approval of Minutes

3.1. Minutes of the business meeting of May 14, 2024

3.1.1. Approved without objection

3.2. Minutes of the special meeting of December 2, 2024

3.2.1. Approved without objection

4. Annual report 2024 of the secretary

4.1. The 2024 Board of the RNAS/KNA consisted of Peter Barthel (chair), Jake Noel-Storr (secretary), Jan Lub (Treasurer until May), Ralph Wijers

(Treasurer since May), Sven De Rijcke, Katie Mulrey, Jacqueline Hodge, and Marijke Haverkorn

4.2. The number of members remained over 500.

4.3. There were two activities, the 79th NAC, and the musical celebration in Haarlem of asteroid (12639) Tonkoopman.

4.4. The planned RNAS/NOVA Teacher's Day had to be postponed.

4.5. A standardized website for the annual NACs was designed and installed.

4.6. The 79th Netherlands Astronomers Conference in Egmond aan Zee was a great success. Well attended: ~250 participants. The first Kees de Jager (education) prize was awarded to Alex de Koter.

4.7. A small rise in membership fees was discussed at the NAC Business Meeting, and later accepted during an on-line extra-ordinary member meeting.

4.8. Migration of website and (member + financial) administration was a major effort, which is nearly completed. An Indico server is now hosted for RNAS for this and future meetings.

4.9. A third Newsletter was e-mailed to all members. Continued focus on rejuvenation and optimal representation of its community, and on improving the Society's value for all members.

4.10. The Board is in regular contact with the EAS, and encourages EAS-activities by the RNAS members.

4.11. The Board expresses sincere thanks to all who have contributed to and supported the Society.

4.12. Updates mid-2025

4.12.1. Membership as of today is at 558 Members (noting that Lost Members and Members without status still contribute somewhat to this figure)

4.12.2. Registration for the NAC this year was 241 participants

4.12.3. Membership database migration in good shape, billing and other handling underway

4.12.4. Website member areas will be developed (working groups; communities; blogs) Inputs welcomed

4.12.5. Next Generation Astronomers – Social Media Takeover for 2 weeks; plus a featured page on the website introducing you to the community

4.12.6. Make the website a community space for Dutch Astronomy

4.12.7. Electronic Documents when approved will be archived in Zenodo (CERN)

4.13. Motion to approve the report and updates moved by the Secretary

4.13.1. Passed without objection

5. Annual report 2024 of the treasurer

5.1. 2024 Financial Statement treasurer

Uitgaven 2024 (in Eur)		Inkomsten 2024 (in Eur)	
secretariaat	0.00	Contributies	590.00
ALV 2024 borrel op NAC	99.20	Donaties	25.00
Kosten website	321.86	Rente spaarrekening	26.50
ING betalingsverkeer	257.69		
kosten nieuwe webserver	433.89		
NNV subsidie La Palma	1500.00		
De Jagerprijs	1500.00		
asteroidefeest Koopman	500.00		
Totaal RNAS/KNA	4612.64		641.50
Netto verlies 2024	3971.14		

Saldi rekeningen	1/1/2024	31/12/2024
lopende rekening	8071.15	4073.51
spaarrekening	20801.47	20827.97
totaal	28872.62	24901.48
afname banksaldo	3971.14	

5.1.1. Comments:

5.1.1.1. Net loss equal to bank change, so okay and understood

5.1.1.2. Expenses normal, income reduced due to no fee collection

5.1.1.3. Higher web site expenses, but much better system

5.1.1.4. New admin and financial system almost complete, doing last bits to get everything going and receive 2025 membership fees

5.1.1.5. Large member increase and auto-pay increase: GOOD (55% of members have direct debit setup, saving 10% each)

5.1.1.6. Audit committee (Icke & Pijpers) discussed and informally approved 2024

5.1.1.7. New budget equilibrium will need to be found: more income, but also more expense

5.2. Report of the financial audit committee

5.2.1. Vince Icke on behalf of the Audit Committee approves the concurrence of the Audit committee with the above statements.

5.3. Motion to approve the 2024 Financial Statement moved by the Treasurer

5.3.1. Seconded: Icke

5.3.2. Motion Passed without objection

5.4. Installation new financial audit committee

5.4.1. Members volunteering: Frank Pijpers, Reynier Peletier

5.5. Motion to approve the 2025 audit committee moved by the Treasurer

5.5.1. Motion Passed without Objection

6. Proposed budget 2025

6.1. Expenses:

	Cost	**Description**
Executive Office	3500	Incudes website, administration fees, EAS participation, migration costs, NAC server
Res. Olympiad	1250	
Prize Reserves	1000	
2025 NAC Grants	1000	
Teacher's Day	500	November 2025
Archive Costs	300	For physical Archive
Contingency	250	

TOTAL	**7800**

6.2. Income:

	Income	**Description**
Membership fees	6000	Reflecting new rate
Interest on saving	250	
TOTAL	**6250**	

6.3. Significant uncertainty, e.g., Olympiad unlikely this year, membership has significant error bar (but not overly optimistic). Some expenses are one-off due to extra changeover work. Prediction: at most small loss, but good thinking about new equilibrium will be needed

6.4. Negative balance not anticipated

6.5. Discussion

6.5.1. Secr.: The meeting registrations of non members is now also an additional income

6.5.2. Member: Olympiad Support? LOCNOC may have comments and thoughts

6.5.3. Co-Treas: controversy over the Olympiad; school numbers are small to participate, which has made removal.

6.5.4. Incoming-Chair: Will coordinate with LOCNOC about what is really happening, maybe include NAEIC about inclusion

6.5.5. Member: New NWO curriculum includes astronomy in physics

6.5.6. Treas.: We welcome input from members

6.5.7. Member: NNV could also advertise it

6.5.8. Incoming-Chair: Discussion has been not to just abolish, so should be rekindled, and maybe have new directions.

6.5.9. Member: asks and BM-SDeR replies there is still a Belgian astronomy Olympiad

6.5.10. Member: What are the costs of the Exec office, treas. Replies these are structural

6.6. Motion to approve the budget of 2025 moved by the Treasurer

6.6.1. Motion passed without objection

6.7. Announcement of the Board, from their meeting of 09 April 2025, of appointment of Board Member Steven Rieder as the new treasurer effective today.

6.7.1. Transition of the Treasurer Role and Responsibilities to Steven Rieder announced by the Chair on behalf of the Board

6.7.2. Our many thanks to Ralph Wijers for his service as treasurer during complicated times for himself, while navigating a complex transition to our new systems. Ralph Wijers will remain as co-treasurer.

7. RNAS house rules, ambitions and plans

7.1. Presented update from 2021 Evaluation Group report. Many items complete. Pending remain:

7.1.1. More relevance of the society, e.g. working groups

7.1.2. Responsible persons in all institutes

7.1.3. More responsibilities for NAC

7.2. The society should take more responsibility and connection for NAC organisation, ensure close connection every year.

7.3. Working Groups proposed and discussed for Art and Creativity, and Education and Outreach.

8. Transfer of Chair

8.1. As approved by the Board in their meeting of 09 April 2025 that Prof. Dr. M. Haverkorn will become the 27th Chair of the Society officially from now.

8.2. Passing of the Gavel

8.2.1. The gavel was passed to MH from PDB on 26 May 2025 at the opening of the NAC conference, in advance of this meeting.

8.3. Thanks to Prof. Dr. P. D. Barthel for his years of service as the chair of the society on behalf of the board and the society

8.3.1. Grateful he will continue in the board and exec committee for the upcoming year to complete archive activities, and ensure a smooth chair transition

9. Any other business

9.1. RJW Welcome any input on how to organize the NAC

9.1.1. Secr. will go to SRON in two weeks to help then transfer to the indico server, NAC email addresses, etc.

9.1.2. Member: NAC is very connected to NOVA, maybe other things that the society can do.

9.1.3. Co-Treasurer will Contact NOVA

9.2. Member: EAS expects input in the area of science, but also in other community areas. We should contribute.

10. Closure

10.1. **Motion to close the meeting and adjourn until May 2026 during the Netherlands Astronomy Conference to be organized by our colleagues from SRON moved by the Secretary**

10.2. Passed without objection

10.3. Meeting adjourned at 16:00h